

DOES THIS SECTION
EVEN NEED AN
INTRODUCTION?
FROM COMPUTERS
TO MOBILES, AND
HEADPHONES TO
GPUS, IT'S ALL
HERE....

THIS MONTH IN TECH:
Learn about a career in
Video Game animation.
Delve into super-
resolution using neural
networks and NVIDIA
DIB-R. Then, head over to
Level Up to up your Twitch
and Prime Video game.



Intel Rocket Lake might have Xe Graphics and PCIe 4.0

Rumours: Intel's upcoming Rocket Lake-S desktop platform might incorporate PCIe 4.0, use the new Xe Graphics architecture, support higher DDR4 speeds and include new overclocking features. Rocket Lake is still expected to be based on Intel's 14nm process but will feature improvements to incorporate the new rumoured features.
<https://digit.in/rocketlake>

WHAT'S NEW

Microsoft unveils DirectX12 Ultimate

Microsoft announced a new featureset to the existing DirectX12 library. Dubbed DirectX 12 Ultimate, the new feature set will support upcoming graphics hardware from AMD, Intel and NVIDIA. The new features supported by DX12 Ultimate include DirectX Raytracing, Variable Rate Shading, Mesh Shaders and Sampler Feedback. Both AMD and NVIDIA have released statements highlighting that their current (NVIDIA RTX) and upcoming (AMD RDNA2) graphics hardware will fully support all the new technologies packaged with DX12 Ultimate. Microsoft also mentioned that DX12 Ultimate will not affect game compatibility with existing hardware, so next gen



AAA-games that use DX12 Ultimate will run just fine on existing hardware. Since both major consoles are slated to incorporate AMD RDNA2 graphics, it would be prudent to assume that studios focused on console-PC game development will adopt the new DirectX standard. On PC, DirectX 12 Ultimate will be available with the next retail version of Windows 10, i.e. Version 20H1, which will probably be released in April 2020 for the general public.

<https://digit.in/dx12ult>

OTT services drop minimum video quality

With many countries around the world going into lockdown the global internet infrastructure has started feeling the brunt as OTT services and video streaming sites see a surge in traffic. As a result, the major OTT and video streaming services have begun dropping the baseline streaming quality to ease the extra load. Netflix confirmed that they will be reducing streaming quality in Europe. Similarly, YouTube is setting the

default streaming quality to HD and Amazon Prime Video is working with service providers



around the world to mitigate congestion. This does not mean that you are not getting what you paid for since users still have manual control over the quality

and can switch up to Full HD or 4K on their streaming services if they wish to. As of now, these measures are only going to be in effect for the next 30 days or so, after which services might be restored to their pre-quarantine levels. Netflix believes that their measures will result in 25% less traffic from Netflix subscribers. At the time of publication, India-based OTT services haven't announced any such measures.

<https://digit.in/hqlq>



Folding@Home faster than Top Supercomputers

Folding@Home has now crossed one exaFLOP of compute power. It's operating with more power than the top 10 supercomputers combined. Folding@Home is currently being used to hunt for a cure for 2019-nCoV.

<https://digit.in/foldathome>



Apple settles "Batterygate" lawsuits

iPhone 6 and 7 owners can rejoice as Apple has agreed to settle multiple class action lawsuits for slowing down older iPhones. Under the settlement, Apple will pay \$25 to the affected and named complainants will receive \$1500 or \$3500.

<https://digit.in/batterygate>



Australia sues FB over Cambridge Analytica

The Office of the Australian Information Commissioner (OAIC), has filed proceedings against Facebook over the Cambridge Analytica scandal. The agency is seeking \$1.7 million per contravention which works out to a potential fine of \$529 Billion.

<https://digit.in/ozsuefb>